



## Dragon Naturally Speaking 6.0

Dragon Naturally Speaking uses L&H Real Speak, Lernout and Hauspie's text to speech engine, which has received many awards from the industry for its superior technology. This engine is based on concatenation algorithms, where actual human voice segments are stored and are used to convert text into speech. Some of the striking features that make this program truly outstanding are:

**NBS:** A special tool called Nothing But Speech filters out gaps, and sounds like 'hmm', 'aaah', etc during dictation, thereby preventing the insertion of unnecessary words.

**Different Modes:** Unlike Office XP, this program provides specific modes for different types of tasks. For instance, there is a special mode that you can use to train the software for dictating numbers, thereby maximising accuracy.

**Acoustic Optimiser:** Most voice recognition software adapt to your speech with time, but this is a gradual process that needs a lot of training time from the user. The Acoustic

Optimiser lets you compile data in a single sweep thereby making the computer learn faster than it would through the 'gradual adaptation process'.

**Add Contact Names:** You can add names to the vocabulary list from Microsoft Outlook or Lotus Notes.

**Navigate the Web:** You can dictate URLs directly in the browser to navigate to the Web site of your choice.

**Command Browser:** It's possible to train commands for specific programs like Outlook, Word, Excel, etc.

**Multiple Users:** Every individual in the family can make their own personal profile and train the software accordingly.

**Custom Macro Commands:** There's a macro recorder that allows you to record custom commands that can be executed at any time.

Dragon Dictate includes a special Indian English installation that makes it easier for Indian users to train and work with it as they don't have to speak in a particular accent. It also features a comprehensive help system and a Microsoft Office XP like

toolbar. Even though its accuracy rate is much higher than Office XP, it still needs considerable training time.

Apart from the professional version there are other flavours of the software that cater to specific professions—medical package, legal suite and public safety suite. The medical package, for instance, features support for generating medical reports, patient notes, and entering data into various forms.

On the whole, Dragon is superior to Office XP's voice recognition feature, even though it's more resource hungry.

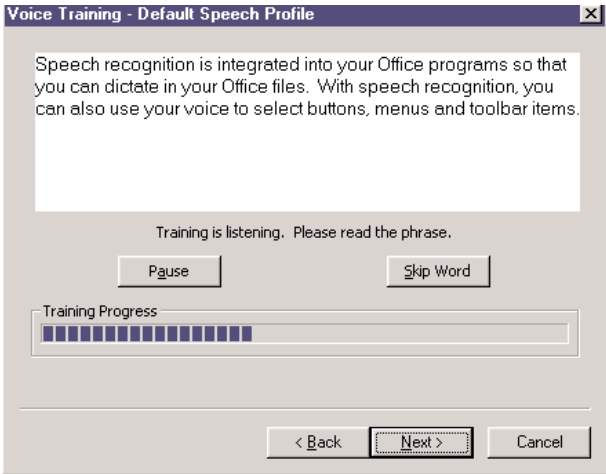
| Dragon Naturally Speaking 6.0 |          | B+ |
|-------------------------------|----------|----|
|                               |          |    |
| Performance                   | ★★★★ 1/2 |    |
| Ease of use                   | ★★★★     |    |
| Value for Money               | ★★★★     |    |
| Features                      | ★★★★     |    |
| OVERALL                       | ★★★★ 1/2 |    |

Web site: [www.scansoft.com](http://www.scansoft.com)

Price: Rs 33,408 (approx.)

### SPECIFICATIONS

**Minimum system requirements:** P-II, 400 MHz processor, soundcard, speakers, 128 MB RAM, 300 MB HDD space, Win 95/98/2000/XP



Read sample sentences to train Office XP

wish to provide more training, you can use sessions such as Aesop's Fable and The Wizard of Oz at a later stage, to attain a higher accuracy level.

### Speak your mind

Now that you've spent time training the software, you can dictate letters, close and open programs, give commands, feed in Excel sheets and create e-mails or Power-

Point presentations without making use of the mouse and keyboard! Here's how you go around accomplishing these tasks:

**Dictation:** Open MS Word and you'll find a Language toolbar at the top. If it doesn't show automatically, go to the 'Tools' menu and click on 'Speech'. On the Speech toolbar click on the 'Microphone' button and you will be able to see the 'Dictation' and 'Voice Command' buttons.

Click on the 'Dictation' button and start speaking slowly. You will see words on the screen, but there will be a small lag as this process is quite CPU-intensive and depends on your processor speed.

While you're dictating, the program will fail to understand several words, especially proper nouns, no matter how loudly or clearly you speak. You will have to manually 'Add' words so that the next

time you speak they are recognised. Click on the 'Tools' button on the Language bar and then click on the 'Add/Delete word' button. You will have to manually type in the word and then speak it out by clicking on the 'Record pronunciation' button. After it's recorded, the word is added to the dictionary. There is another option called 'Learn from document', which lets you add words that are not recognised automatically.



## Drawing and Writing Freehand

You can write or draw with your mouse or PC tablet, using the 'Write anywhere', 'Drawing pad' and 'Writing pad' options on the Language bar. In order to write on the screen, select 'Write anywhere' and use your mouse to write.

If you would like to draw freehand diagrams, select the 'Drawing pad' option. There's even an on-screen keyboard, which allows you to type without using your actual keyboard!